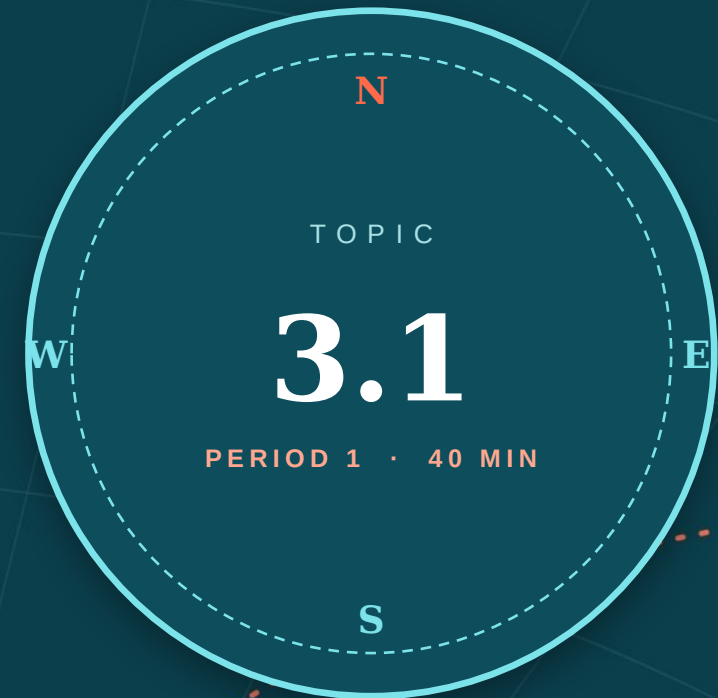


UNIT 3 · TOPIC 3.1

Introduction to Fare Basis Codes

Reading the DNA of an airfare.

B.B.A. Aviation Management · Semester III · Unit 3: Fare Construction (Advanced)
Air Ticketing & Fare Construction (2ACBAM32) · Arun Kumar



TOPIC 3.1

Expedition Preview: Topic Intro



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02

TOPIC 3.1

Navigator's Question



THINK ABOUT IT

Fare basis codes look like secret code. What clues can letters and numbers hide?

**THINK**

30 seconds alone

**PAIR**

1 minute with a neighbour

**SHARE**

2–3 answers with the class



TOPIC 3.1

Route Map for Today

1

3.1.1

Definition of fare basis codes: role and structure

2

3.1.2

Components: letters and numbers for class, season and restrictions

3

3.1.3

Examples of fare basis codes

4

3.1.4

Review of common codes like Y, M, B, S and their meaning



COURSE OBJECTIVES

- Explain the role of a fare basis code
- Identify primary and secondary code elements
- Interpret sample codes
- Rank common RBDs by price and flexibility

Pedagogy: Lecture-Based Teaching–Learning

TOPIC 3.1.1

The Role of a Fare Basis Code

Unit 3 builds on Topic 2.3 — now at an advanced level.

**Unique identifier**

Points to one fare and its full rule set.

**Printed on each coupon**

Airport and revenue staff use it to check validity.

**Used in repricing**

Changes and refunds start from the original fare basis.

**STRUCTURE**

Prime code (RBD letter) + optional modifiers (season, day, fare type, AP, stay, market) = fare basis code of up to 8 characters. A ticket designator (e.g., /CH25) may follow for discounts.



TOPIC 3.1.1

Who Uses the Code?



Agents

Quote, reprice and explain rules.



Airport Staff

Validate tickets at check-in.



Revenue Accounting

Audit and prorate ticket value.



Call Centres

Answer change/refund questions.

TOPIC 3.1.2

Primary & Secondary Elements

Element	Common codes	Meaning
Prime code	F, J, C, W, Y, B, M, H, Q...	Cabin / booking class
Season	H, K, L (also J/F in some systems)	High, shoulder, low season
Day of week	W, X	Weekend, weekday
Fare type	E / EE, AP, PX, OW, RT	Excursion, advance purchase, one-way, return
Numbers	7, 14, 21 / 3M, 6M	Advance purchase days / max stay



TOPIC 3.1.2

Adding a Ticket Designator

Discounts are shown after a slash.

- The fare basis stays the same as the adult fare.
- A ticket designator shows the discount type.
- CH = child, IN = infant, SD = student (varies).
- Numbers show the % discount.

FARE BASIS + DESIGNATOR (illustrative)

ADULT	MLRT
CHILD	MLRT/CH25
INFANT	MLRT/IN90
STUDENT	MLRT/SD10

// CH25 = 25% child discount
// IN90 = 90% infant discount

TOPIC 3.1.3

Decoding Real-Style Examples

**YIF**

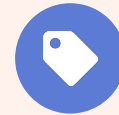
Y-class, IATA full-fare economy: fully flexible.

**BHXAP**

B-class, high season, weekday, advance purchase.

**SKEE6M**

S-class, shoulder season excursion, max 6 months.

**QLOW**

Q-class, low season, one-way.



TOPIC 3.1.3

Same Flight, Two Codes

**YRT**

- Full-fare economy return
- Change and refund free
- Highest economy price
- Seat almost always available

vs**QLX21RT**

- Discount economy return
- Low season, weekday travel
- 21-day advance purchase
- Penalties apply



TOPIC 3.1.4

Common RBD Ladder (Typical)

Higher on the ladder = more expensive, more flexible.

Code	Typical position	Flexibility
Y	Full-fare economy	Fully flexible
B	High discount economy	Good flexibility
M	Mid-level economy	Moderate
H / K	Lower economy	Restricted
S / Q / V	Deep discount / promo	Most restricted

Note: Order varies by airline — always check the carrier's own RBD chart.

Air Ticketing & Fare Construction · Unit 3: Fare Construction (Advanced) · Topic 3.1

TOPIC 3.1.4

Lecture Recap

RBD

first letter = class

+Mods

season, day, type

/TD

ticket designator = discount



Never guess — display the fare rule to confirm what a code allows.

TOPIC 3.1

Navigation Exercise: Code Relay



PEDAGOGY

Lecture-Based Teaching-Learning

TIME · 8 min

FORMAT · Whole class, rows compete

1

Instructor displays a fare basis code.

2

First student in each row decodes one element and passes on.

3

Row that decodes all elements correctly first wins a point.

4

Five rounds; finish with a code including a ticket designator.



TOPIC 3.1

[Click to reveal each answer](#)

Position Check Quiz

Q1**YIF usually indicates...**

- A) Infant fare
- B) Full-fare economy
- C) Promo fare
- D) First class

ANSWER

B**Q2****“/CH25” after a fare basis means...**

- A) 25 kg bag
- B) Child 25% discount
- C) Charter
- D) Change fee 25

ANSWER

B**Q3****“X” in a fare basis code often means...**

- A) Weekday
- B) Excursion
- C) Extra bag
- D) Exchange

ANSWER

A**Q4****Which code is typically the most restricted?**

- A) Y
- B) B
- C) M
- D) Q

ANSWER

D

DESTINATION REACHED

Key Takeaways

- ✓ Fare basis code = prime RBD + modifiers, up to 8 characters
- ✓ Ticket designators show discounts (e.g., /CH25)
- ✓ Codes guide validation, repricing and accounting
- ✓ RBD ladders run from flexible Y to restricted promo classes

EXIT TICKET Write 1 thing you learned today + 1 question you still have.

NEXT WAYPOINT

Topic 3.2 — International vs Domestic Fare Construction

Thank you · Questions?

